



“When we are selling our ideas, the audience must first buy *us*.”

Peter Coughter, *The Art of the Pitch*, 2012



DO...

- › **Keep it short** and to the point, and make your first sentence count.
- › **Invite the audience** to ask questions, and listen to them carefully.
- › **Make sure you** have evidence for claims (such as market research).
- › **Show enthusiasm** for and belief in your ideas; demonstrate motivation.
- › **Stay relaxed**—head up, with good posture.
- › **Speak at a steady** pace, especially at the start of your pitch.
- › **Use powerful images** to back up the messages in the presentation.

DON'T...

- › **Be unrealistic** about financial projections.
- › **Focus too much** on technical detail or jargon.
- › **Assume your** audience will share your enthusiasm (you must persuade them)
- › **Talk too much** about yourself—focus on the business.
- › **Read directly** from a screen or turn your back on the audience if presenting in person.
- › **Fidget**—this can be distracting.
- › **Overload visuals** with words, bullet points, and complicated graphics.

Who will buy?

You must show there is sufficient demand and the business can actually meet that demand. Otherwise, investment could be too risky.

What about the competitors?

Your business needs to either create a new market or beat its rivals to provide a realistic return on investment.